Elite Workout Manual

Chapter 11 – Exercise Library & Technique Guide

Objective

Provide quick-reference coaching cues, common mistakes, and substitutions for the primary exercises in your program.

Exercise	Key Setup & Cues	Common Mistake	Substitution
Barbell Bench Press	Feet planted, shoulder blades retracted, bar to chest.	Flared elbows, bouncing bar.	DB Bench Press
Chest-Supported Row	Chest on pad, pull elbows to hips.	Shrugging shoulders.	Seated Cable Row
Hack Squat	Brace core, full depth you can control.	Partial reps.	Leg Press
Romanian Deadlift	Hinge at hips, neutral spine, bar close.	Rounding lower back.	45° Back Extension
Lat Pulldown	Drive elbows down, pause at chest.	Pulling behind neck.	Assisted Pull-up
Overhead Press	Brace core, press vertically.	Overarching lower back.	Machine Shoulder Press
Cable Lateral Raise	Lead with elbows, slight bend.	Swinging body.	DB Lateral Raise
Face Pull	Pull to eyes with external rotation.	Using excessive weight.	Reverse Pec Deck
Dead Hang	Active shoulders, full grip.	Relaxing shoulders completely.	Farmer's Carry

Breathing & Bracing

Brace your core before each heavy repetition. Inhale before lowering the weight, maintain trunk tension through the hardest portion of the lift, and exhale under control after passing the sticking point.

Tempo Guide

• Heavy compounds: controlled lowering (2–3 seconds), powerful concentric.
• Isolation work: 2-second lowering, brief pause, controlled lifting.
• Never sacrifice technique for speed.

Exercise Selection Philosophy

Each exercise was chosen because it offers a strong stimulus-to-fatigue ratio, supports your goals, and fits within your available training time. Exercises that duplicated the same movement pattern were intentionally omitted.

Coach's Notes

Master technique before chasing heavier weights. A technically sound set with slightly less weight produces better long-term progress than a heavier set performed with poor mechanics.